

Collects and Biographies for

# **Saints' Days & Festivals**

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

*December*

## Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

## Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

## Key to Abbreviations

|       |                                                          |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| CCP   | Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)        |
| EH    | Exciting Holiness (2nd edition, 2003)                    |
| EM    | The English Missal                                       |
| ECUSA | Episcopal Church of the United States of America         |
| F     | Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)       |
| LFF   | The proper for the Lesser Feasts and Fasts, 1991 (ECUSA) |
| MEG   | Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon                        |
| PHG   | The Promise of His Glory (C of E, 1990)                  |
| R     | The Roman Missal (1970)                                  |
| SEC   | Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects           |
| SPB   | Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967            |

## Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J M Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

## 1 DECEMBER

### Charles de Foucauld, Priest and Hermit (1916) [6] *White*

Charles Eugène de Foucauld was a French cavalry officer and explorer who, in 1883, undertook a hazardous expedition in Morocco. This was followed by a period of great spiritual unrest, at the end of which he returned to the Roman Catholic faith. He then undertook a pilgrimage to the Holy Land, and entered a Trappist monastery. After seven years he sought even greater solitude and austerity, and eventually settled as a hermit in Algeria, where his personal piety and acts of charity won widespread admiration. He was assassinated by Tuaregs\* in 1916 in the course of a Holy War.

(\* 'Tuareg' is an Arabic word widely used by the French, meaning "abandoned by the gods". The Tuaregs have always lived in the west-African territories, ancient colonies of the French empire the French called 'Afrique Occidentale Française'. *from the Tuareg website*)

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord God, our heavenly Father,  
by whose grace  
thy servant  
Charles de Foucauld was faithful  
to Christ's example  
of poverty and humility:  
strengthen us by thy Holy Spirit,  
that we too  
may be faithful in our calling,  
and bring us, we pray thee,  
to the perfection  
thou hast made known to us  
in thy blessed Son;  
who now liveth and reigneth  
with thee and the Holy Spirit,  
one God, for ever and ever.

*(R – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,  
you called your servant  
Charles de Foucauld  
to seek your kingdom  
in this world by  
striving to live in perfect charity:  
may his example give us courage,  
and help us to move forward  
with joyful hearts in the way of love:  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R)*

## 2 DECEMBER

### Nicholas Ferrar, Deacon (1637) [6] *White*

A native of London, Nicholas Ferrar had a brilliant career at Cambridge, and after some years travelling on the continent was in the employ of the Virginia Company. He was elected to Parliament, but gave up a promising political career to settle in 1625 at Little Gidding, near Huntingdon, where his family, with those of his brother and his brother-in-law established a religious community “in accordance with the principles of the Church of England”.

Their piety was warmly approved, and the community was active in charitable works throughout the neighbourhood, visiting the sick, relieving the poor and teaching children.

Ferrar died in 1537, and in 1646 the community was destroyed by a Puritan raid as subversive to the principles of the Reformation.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God of peace,  
who didst inspire thy servant  
Nicholas Ferrar and his household  
to strive to live together  
according to thy commandments:  
make us worthy of thy perfect love,  
and grant us thy grace  
that we may rule ourselves  
after thy Word  
and serve thee with our whole heart;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(CCP – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God of peace:  
make us worthy of your perfect love,  
that, with your servant  
Nicholas Ferrar and his household,  
we may rule ourselves  
after your Word and serve you  
with our whole heart;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(CCP)*

### 3 DECEMBER

#### Francis Xavier, Deacon (1637) [6] *White*

Born in Spain in 1506, he studied at Paris, and there came under the influence of Saint Ignatius Loyola. He was one of the original seven Jesuits who dedicated themselves to God at Montmartre in 1534. He was ordained priest at Rome, and 4 years later was sent as a missionary to Portuguese India, where he protested fiercely against the oppression of the native peoples by European colonists.

In 1549 he went to Japan, and after two years left Japanese converts in charge of his mission to return to India. The next year he set out for China, then a country closed to foreigners, but died in 1552, aged 46, on an island at the mouth of the Canton river.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God our Father,  
who didst win  
many souls for thy service  
through the preaching  
of Saint Francis Xavier:  
renew us with his zeal for the faith,  
and let thy Church rejoice  
to see the virtue and number  
of her children  
increase throughout the world;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,  
you won many nations to yourself  
by the preaching of Francis Xavier:  
give us the same zeal he had  
for the faith,  
and let your Church rejoice  
to see the virtue and the number  
of her children increase  
throughout the world;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R)*

## 4 DECEMBER

### **Clement of Alexandria, Teacher of the Faith (c.210) [6] *White***

An Athenian by birth, he studied in Alexandria, and succeeded Pantaenus as head of the Catechetical School there in AD 190. Forced to flee in the persecution of AD 202, he was succeeded by his pupil Origen.

His teaching and writings have been thought to include elements of Gnostic philosophy, which is why his name was removed from the calendar at the Counter-Reformation, although it always featured in the early lists of saints.

He died around the year AD 210.

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God,  
who hast enlightened thy Church  
by the teaching  
of thy Confessor and Doctor,  
Saint Clement of Alexandria:  
enrich it evermore, we beseech thee,  
with thy heavenly grace,  
and raise up teachers therein  
who may set forth thy truth  
as well by sound doctrine  
as by holiness of life;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F)

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Lord God, you filled your servant  
Clement of Alexandria  
with heavenly wisdom  
to teach the truth as it is in Christ:  
in the power of your Holy Spirit  
help us to remain true to that faith  
in all that we do,  
and by our example  
to commend it to others;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
*(R – adapted)*

## 6 DECEMBER

### Nicholas of Myra, Bishop (4th Century) [6] *White*

Nicholas was Bishop of Myra in Lycia (now Turkey), where he died about the middle of the 4th century. He is honoured for the piety of his life, and his works of charity. Despite his popularity, little is known for certain of his life. He is honoured as the patron saint of sailors, and of children, with his symbol in art being the three bags of gold he is said to have given as dowry to three sisters to save them from a life of prostitution. Nicholas is the original behind the folk legend of Santa Claus. He is also one of the patron saints of Russia.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, our Heavenly Father,  
who didst raise up  
thy faithful servant Nicholas  
to be a bishop in thy Church  
and to feed thy flock:  
give to all pastors  
the abundant gifts of thy Holy Spirit,  
that they may generously minister  
in thy household  
as true servants of Christ  
and stewards of the treasures  
of thy holy mysteries;  
through the same  
Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(ECUSA – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty Father,  
lover of souls,  
you chose your servant Nicholas  
to be a bishop in the Church  
that he might give freely  
out of the treasures of your grace:  
make your people mindful  
of the needs of others,  
and as they have  
themselves received,  
so teach then also to give;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(PHG)*

## 7 DECEMBER

### **Ambrose of Milan, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith (397) [6]** *White*

Born at Trier in AD 339, Ambrose studied law at Rome, entered the public service, and then, while living at Milan as Governor, was unexpectedly chosen as bishop in 374, although only a catechumen at the time. Milan was then the administrative centre of the whole of the western part of the Roman empire.

He carried out his work assiduously, as a true shepherd and teacher of the faithful, and was renowned for his works of charity. He defended the true faith against the Arians, and strenuously guarded the rights of the Church, even against the emperor himself. He was the first western teacher to use hymns extensively as a way of expressing praise and fostering right belief, and some of his hymns survive today. He died on Easter Eve, in the year 397.

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God,  
who didst give to  
thy servant Ambrose  
grace eloquently to proclaim  
thy righteousness  
in the great congregation,  
and fearlessly to bear reproach  
for the honour of thy Name:  
mercifully grant  
to all bishops and pastors  
such excellency in preaching,  
and fidelity in ministering thy Word,  
that thy people may be  
partakers with thee of the glory  
that shall be revealed;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(ECUSA – LFF)*

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

God of hosts,  
you called Ambrose  
from the governor's throne  
to the episcopal seat  
and made him  
the intrepid champion  
of your faithful people:  
mercifully grant that,  
as he did not fear to rebuke rulers,  
so we, with like courage,  
may affirm the faith  
which we believe;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
*(CCP)*

## 8 DECEMBER

### **The Conception of Mary, Mother of the Lord [5] *White***

This festival in honour of the conception of the mother of our Lord is celebrated on this day in both the eastern and the western Church. The feast which dates from the 7th century, acknowledges the preparation by God of his people to receive their Saviour and Lord, putting 'heaven in ordinary' and showing that mortal flesh can indeed bring Christ to the world.

*(Exciting Holiness (2003), p.552)*

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O Almighty God,  
who didst endue with singular grace  
the Blessed Virgin Mary,  
the Mother of our Lord:  
vouchsafe, we beseech thee,  
to hallow our bodies in purity  
and our souls in humility and love;  
through the same  
our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

*(SPB)*

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty and everlasting God,  
who stooped to raise fallen humanity  
through the child-bearing  
of blessed Mary:  
grant that we,  
who have seen your glory  
revealed in our human nature  
and your love made perfect  
in our weakness,  
may daily be renewed in your image  
and conformed to the pattern  
of your Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(EH)*

## 14 DECEMBER

### **John of the Cross, Priest, Teacher of the Faith (1591) [6] *White***

Born at Fontiveros, near Avila, in Old Castile, Spain, around the year 1542, Juan de Yepes was brought up by his widowed mother and went to a charity school. He worked as a nurse and received further education from the Jesuits before entering the Carmelite order when he was twenty-one. About 1568 he was persuaded by Saint Teresa of Avila to undertake the reform of his Order, which cost him much hard work and many trials, including brutal imprisonment from which he escaped after nine months.

He was outstanding in holiness and knowledge, as his many spiritual writings testify. His spiritual teachings arise from his own experience nourished by a deep study of the Scriptures, and are expressed with a remarkable literary beauty. He died at Ubeda in Andalusia after a severe illness on this day in 1591.

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God,  
who didst endue thy blessed servant  
John with perfect self-denial  
and a surpassing love of the Cross:  
mercifully grant that,  
continually cleaving to his example,  
we may attain unto everlasting  
glory;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(EM)

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

God in heaven,  
you gave your servant  
John of the Cross  
the gift of a mystical knowledge  
of you:  
grant to all who faithfully love you  
union of body and soul  
in Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

**21 DECEMBER**  
**Thomas, Apostle [4] Red**  
*If not kept on 3 July*

Thomas is mentioned among the number of the apostles in the gospels of Matthew, Mark and Luke but it is in John's gospel that his significance is revealed. First, he is heard encouraging the other disciples to go to Judea with Jesus; then, not knowing what Jesus meant when he talked about where he was to go elicited the answer that Jesus was himself the Way. But probably most famously was he the apostle notably unconvinced by reports of the resurrection of Jesus, causing Jesus to show him the marks in his hands and side. Thomas then acclaims the risen Christ with the words that have been described as the great climax to John's gospel: "My Lord and my God".

Nothing certain is known of his life after this, but there is a strong tradition that he went to India to preach the Gospel.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty and everliving God,  
who for the more confirmation  
of the faith  
didst suffer thy holy Apostle Thomas  
to be doubtful  
in thy Son's resurrection:  
grant us so perfectly,  
and without all doubt,  
to believe in thy Son Jesus Christ,  
that our faith in thy sight  
may never be reprieved.  
Hear us, O Lord,  
through the same Jesus Christ,  
to whom, with thee and the Holy  
Ghost be all honour and glory, now  
and for evermore.

*(SPB)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty and eternal God,  
who, for the firmer foundation  
of our faith,  
allowed your holy apostle Thomas  
to doubt the resurrection of your Son  
till word and sight convinced him:  
grant to us, who have not seen,  
that we also may believe  
and so confess Christ as our Lord  
and our God;  
who is alive and reigns with you,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

*(SEC)*

**24 DECEMBER**  
**Christmas Eve [3] *White***

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty God,  
who makest us glad  
with the yearly remembrance  
of the birth of thy Son:  
grant that we  
who joyfully receive him  
for our redeemer,  
may with sure confidence  
behold him when he shall come  
to be our judge;  
who liveth and reigneth with thee,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, world without end.

*(SPB)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty God,  
you make us glad  
with the yearly remembrance  
of the birth of your Son Jesus Christ:  
grant that, as we joyfully receive  
him as our redeemer, we may  
with sure confidence behold him  
when he shall come to be our judge;  
who lives and reigns with you,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

*(SEC)*

**24 DECEMBER**  
**Christmas Night [3] *White***

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Eternal God,  
who madest this most holy night  
to shine with the brightness  
of thy one true light:  
bring us, who have known  
the revelation of that light on earth,  
to see the radiance  
of thy heavenly glory;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord,  
who liveth and reigneth with thee,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, world without end.

*(SEC – adapted)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Eternal God,  
who made this most holy night  
to shine with the brightness  
of your one true light:  
bring us, who have known  
the revelation of that light on earth,  
to see the radiance  
of your heavenly glory;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord,  
who is alive and reigns with you,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

*(SEC)*

**25 DECEMBER**  
**CHRISTMAS DAY [1] *White***

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty God,  
who hast given us  
thy only-begotten Son  
to take our nature upon him,  
and as at this time to be born  
of a pure Virgin:  
Grant that we being regenerate,  
and made thy children  
by adoption and grace,  
may daily be renewed  
by thy Holy Spirit;  
through the same  
Our Lord Jesus Christ,  
who liveth and reigneth  
with thee and the same Spirit,  
ever one God, world without end.

*(SPB)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty God,  
you have given us  
your only-begotten Son  
to take our nature upon him  
and as at this time to be born  
of a pure virgin:  
grant that we,  
who have been born again  
and made your children  
by adoption and grace,  
may daily be renewed  
by your Holy Spirit;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord,  
who is alive and reigns with you,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

*(SEC)*

**26 DECEMBER**  
**Stephen, Deacon and Martyr [4] *Red***

Stephen was one of the seven Greek-speaking Jews chosen by the apostles as the first deacons to care for the poor among the Christian community. He became a powerful preacher and the worker of many miracles, thus arousing the hostility of the Sanhedrin, before whom he was tried as a blasphemer. Claiming a vision of Jesus at the right hand of God, he was stoned to death, apparently without the formality of a proper trial and verdict, the first to die for his faith in the divinity of Jesus. As he died, following the Lord's example, he prayed for forgiveness for these who killed him. Saul of Tarsus was a Witness to his death.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Grant, O Lord,  
that in all our sufferings  
here upon earth,  
for the testimony of thy truth,  
we may steadfastly look up to  
heaven,  
and by faith behold the glory  
that shall be revealed;  
and, being filled with the Holy  
Ghost,  
may learn to love  
and bless our persecutors,  
by the example of thy first Martyr  
Saint Stephen,  
who prayed for his murderers  
to thee, O blessed Jesus,  
who standest  
at the right hand of God  
to succour all those that suffer  
for thee, our only Mediator  
and Advocate.

(SPB)

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Gracious Father,  
who gave the first martyr  
Stephen  
grace to pray for those  
who took up stones against him:  
grant that in all our sufferings  
for the truth  
we may learn to love  
even our enemies  
and to seek forgiveness  
for those who desire our hurt,  
looking up to heaven  
to him who was crucified for us,  
Jesus Christ our mediator  
and advocate.

(SEC)

## 27 DECEMBER

### John, Apostle and Evangelist [4] *White*

John, the son of Zebedee and younger brother of James, was one of the inner group of Jesus's disciples, who accompanied Him at the raising of Jairus's daughter and the Transfiguration, and was a witness of the Agony in Gethsemane. In the resurrection stories and the Acts of the Apostles, John is frequently mentioned with Peter, which suggests he occupied a position of prominence among the apostles. He was imprisoned with Peter, and with him he was sent to Samaria to bestow the gift of the Holy Spirit on the new converts, and he was present at the Council at Jerusalem when it was agreed that Gentiles should be accepted as full members of the Church without adopting Jewish practices.

Tradition identifies him with the "disciple whom Jesus loved" in the Fourth Gospel, and ascribes its authorship to him. Another tradition, less widely held now, identifies him also with the author of the final book in the New Testament, written by an exile on the island of Patmos, but the links between John and Ephesus are widely attested. Of the occasion and manner of his death, nothing is certain, but according to tradition he lived to be a very old man, and was the one apostle not to suffer a martyr's death.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

Merciful Lord,  
we beseech thee to cast  
thy bright beams of light  
upon thy Church,  
that it being enlightened  
by the doctrine of thy blessed  
Apostle and Evangelist Saint John  
may so walk in the light of thy truth,  
that it may at length attain  
to the light of everlasting life;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Merciful Lord,  
cast your bright beams  
of light upon the Church;  
that, being enlightened  
by the teaching of your blessed  
apostle and evangelist John,  
we may so walk  
in the light of your truth  
that we may at last attain  
to the light of everlasting life;  
through Jesus Christ  
your incarnate Son our Lord.

(SEC)

**28 DECEMBER**  
**The Holy Innocents [4] *White***

The memory of the children of Bethlehem “from two years old and under”, who were slain by the insanely jealous King Herod in an attempt to eliminate Jesus as a rival to his throne, has always been venerated by the Church as martyrs who bore witness to the Saviour they did not know. It is probable that they were not a large number, but they are seen also as representatives of the countless children in every age who have suffered violence and injustice.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O Almighty God,  
who out of the mouths of  
babes and sucklings  
hast ordained strength,  
and madest infants to glorify thee  
by their deaths:  
mortify and kill all vices in us,  
and so strengthen us by thy grace,  
that by the innocence of our lives,  
and constancy of our faith,  
even unto death,  
we may glorify thy holy Name;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(SPB)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Heavenly Father,  
whose children suffered  
at the hands of Herod,  
though they had done no wrong:  
by the suffering of your Son  
and by the innocence of our lives  
frustrate all evil designs  
and establish your reign  
of justice and peace;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(SEC)*

## 29 DECEMBER

### Thomas Becket of Canterbury, Bishop and Martyr (1170) [6] *Red*

Born at Cheapside in London in 1118, he was a priest at Canterbury, and became Chancellor of England under Henry II in 1155. He served the king faithfully and wisely as statesman, diplomat and soldier, and as a close friend.

In 1162 he was made Archbishop of Canterbury, in which office he lived austere and devoutly, and strenuously defended the rights of the Church against the king. He was exiled to France for 6 years, and on his return to England on 1 December 1170 the quarrel with the king broke out afresh, and early in the evening of 29 December he was murdered in his Cathedral by the king's followers. He was spontaneously acclaimed as a martyr, and his shrine at Canterbury became, until the Reformation, one of the major pilgrim resorts of Europe.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,  
by whose grace and power  
thy blessed bishop Thomas  
triumphed over suffering  
and was faithful even unto death:  
grant us, who now remember him  
with thanksgiving,  
to be so faithful  
in our witness to thee,  
that we may receive with him  
the crown of life;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Lord God, you gave grace  
to your servant Thomas Becket  
to put aside all earthly fear  
and be faithful even to death:  
grant that we,  
disregarding earthly acclaim,  
may fight all wrong,  
uphold your rule,  
and serve you to our life's end;  
through your incarnate Son,  
Jesus Christ our Lord,  
who is alive and reigns  
with you and the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

(CCP – *adapted*)

**30 DECEMBER**  
**Josephine Butler (1905) [6] *White***

Josephine Butler (née Grey) was born in Northumberland in April 1828, and baptized on 30 May of the same year, the date she is remembered in the Church of England.

The wife of a Canon of Winchester, she was passionately concerned for social reform, her main interests being the rescue of prostitutes and the suppression of the “white slave trade”. Her activities extended to national and international dimensions, and behind them lay a life of almost continuous prayer modelled on the example of Saint Catherine of Siena.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God, the Father of all,  
who hast taught us  
in thy blessed Son  
that the laws of heaven  
are fulfilled in love for thee  
and love for our neighbour:  
grant us, we beseech thee,  
that by following the example  
of thy devoted servant  
Josephine Butler  
in practising works of charity  
we may be numbered  
among the blessed in thy kingdom  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R – adapted)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

God of compassion and love,  
by your grace, your servant  
Josephine Butler  
followed in the way  
of your incarnate Son  
in caring for those in need:  
help us, like her,  
to work with strength  
for the restoration of all  
to the dignity and freedom  
of those created in your image;  
through Jesus Christ our Saviour.  
*(CCP)*

## 31 DECEMBER

### John Wycliffe, Priest (1384) [6] *White*

A native of Richmond in Yorkshire, John Wycliffe (or Wyclif) was a scholar at Oxford (a fellow at Merton College, and Master of Balliol), and held various parochial appointments, the most notable being Lutterworth in Leicestershire, where he died in 1384, whilst at Mass.

He gained an early reputation as a philosopher, and his attitude towards the Church grew increasingly radical, seeking more and more the sole basis of all doctrinal formulations in the Scriptures. He did much to encourage the translation of the Scriptures into contemporary English in order to make the words of life available to all, although it is doubtful whether he himself played any significant part in the work of translation.

He has been called “the Morning Star of the Reformation”, and his teachings, popularized by the Lollards, had a significant influence in the years leading up to the Reformation. He died on this day in 1384, whilst at Mass.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord Jesus Christ,  
Eternal Word of the Father:  
grant, we beseech thee,  
that as thy servant John Wycliffe  
was fired with zeal  
for the reform of thy Church,  
so we may grow  
in the knowledge and love  
of thy blessed will  
as revealed to us  
through the holy Scriptures  
and the Spirit of truth,  
and so come  
to thy heavenly kingdom,  
where thou livest and reignest  
with the Father and the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and ever.

*(MEG from CCP)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal Word,  
grant that as your servant  
John Wycliffe was fired with zeal  
for the reform of your Church,  
so we may grow  
in the knowledge and love  
of your will as revealed to us  
through the holy Scriptures  
and the Spirit of truth,  
and so come to be with you  
in your heavenly Kingdom,  
where you live and reign  
with the Father and the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and ever.  
*(CCP – adapted)*

# December

|    |                                                          |          |              |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------|
| 1  | Charles de Foucauld, Priest and Hermit, 1916             | 6        | White        |
| 2  | Nicholas Ferrar, Deacon, 1637                            | 6        | White        |
| 3  | Francis Xavier, Priest and Missionary, 1552              | 6        | White        |
| 4  | Clement of Alexandria, Teacher of the Faith, c.210       | 6        | White        |
| 5  | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 6  | Nicholas of Myra, Bishop, 4th century                    | 6        | White        |
| 7  | Ambrose of Milan, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith, c.210 | 6        | White        |
| 8  | The Conception of Mary, Mother of the Lord               | 5        | White        |
| 9  | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 10 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 11 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 12 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 13 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 14 | John of the Cross, Priest, Teacher of the Faith, 1591    | 6        | White        |
| 15 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 16 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 17 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 18 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 19 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 20 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 21 | <b>Thomas, Apostle (if not kept on 3 July)</b>           | <b>4</b> | <b>Red</b>   |
| 22 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 23 | —                                                        | —        | —            |
| 24 | <b>Christmas Eve</b>                                     | <b>3</b> | <b>White</b> |
| 25 | <b>CHRISTMAS DAY</b>                                     | <b>1</b> | <b>White</b> |
| 26 | <b>Stephen, Deacon and Martyr</b>                        | <b>4</b> | <b>Red</b>   |
| 27 | <b>John, Apostle and Evangelist</b>                      | <b>4</b> | <b>White</b> |
| 28 | <b>The Holy Innocents</b>                                | <b>4</b> | <b>White</b> |
| 29 | Thomas of Canterbury, Bishop and Martyr, 1170            | 6        | Red          |
| 30 | Josephine Butler, 1905                                   | 6        | White        |
| 31 | John Wycliffe, Priest, 1384                              | 6        | White        |